

Cyber 9/12 – Round 1

Response phase 1 (Uzair, ~1m40s): Bulleted Outline: 1:39s

- Thank you. (To [REDACTED], for the overview of KSC and passing it over to me)
- **Phase 1** of our policy recommendations is: Continued Intelligence & Investigation
- **Goal(s):** The key objectives of this phase are: intelligence expansion, intentional restraint to manage legal and escalation risk, infrastructure mapping, legal containment, and avoiding premature disruption.
- In phase 1, our **first recommendation** is: Establish an Interagency Task Force
 - Policy/Stakeholders: NSC convenes “ITF”, which involves the FBI, CISA, & EPA, to oversee policy executions, align law enforcement, & cyber defense strategies.
- **Second recommendation:** PESTIS Infected Infrastructure Map (Rule 41)
 - Policy/Stakeholders: NSC authorizes the FBI, **under** DOJ supervision & oversight, to pursue a Rule 41 warrant, **strictly** scoped to remote access for infrastructure mapping, **NOT** takedown or disruption.
- **Third recommendation:** RUGRAT Bitcoin Wallets
 - Policy/Stakeholders: Recommend the FBI and Treasury jointly trace RUGRAT Bitcoin wallets and identify cash-out points to aid attribution.
- **Fourth recommendation:** Confidential TLP:RED advisory E-ISAC/MFG-ISAC
 - Policy/Stakeholders: The NSC issue conf. TLP:RED advisory to Electricity/Manufacturing Information Sharing & Analysis Center. We advise at-risk members take a “shields-up” stance & stay vigilant for anomalous behaviors.
- **Timeline(s):** The timeline for all phase 1 policy recommendations: start promptly, within 3-5 business days.
- **Potential Drawbacks:** While Phase 1 does not initially halt malicious activity,
- **Benefits:** it has low escalation risk, maintains operational security, & aids further policies.
- **Escalation:** Next, [REDACTED] will cover Phase 2.

Closing and conclusion (Uzair, ~30 seconds): Rough Outline: 25s

- **Closing:** Today, we outlined the threat environment facing U.S. critical infrastructure and presented a phased response to manage uncertainty while protecting essential services.
- **Call to Action:** Due to the risks posed by PESTIS and RUGRAT, it is imperative that we act promptly, preemptively, and planned.
- **Bridge:** Our phased approach reduces escalation risks while allowing decisive action later if the situation worsens.
- **Conclusion:** Thank you for your time. We welcome your questions.

Cyber 9/12 – Round 2

Response Phase 1 (Uzair, ~1m40s):

- Thank you, [REDACTED]
- **Phase 1** of our policy recommendation is: Immediate Stabilization & Economic Risk Containment.
- **Goal(s):** The key objectives of this phase are: stabilize affected systems & mitigate cascading economic effects.
- In phase 1, our **first recommendation** is to immediately raise the **NCISS** priority level to **High** to raise funds, within 24-48 hours, due to the demonstrable cascading economic effects caused by the disruption of the Touchstone semiconductor production facility.
- **Second Recommendation:** Within 1-2 weeks, eradicate the PESTIS infection by using the forensic findings and collected TTPs by CISA and the FBI to assist Touchstone and its municipal water supplier. The goal is to recover water quality for semiconductor production to minimize further disruption to the U.S. semiconductor economy.
 - Ideally, **within 2-4 weeks**, government entities approach cloud providers regarding illegal activity on their systems that may be in **breach** of terms and conditions, **encouraging** government collaboration for secure & **time-coordinated** takedown of C2 infrastructure.
- **Third Recommendation:** With a 4-8 week **target**, we recommend that the ODNI, in coordination with the DOJ, authorize limited declassification of PESTIS IoC. Under FBI coordination, major cloud providers should be directed to preserve, **NOT** disrupt, infrastructure exhibiting **IoC** to **avoid** triggering PESTIS C2 bot malware and **support** further investigation efforts.
- **Benefits:** escalates the priority level, stabilizes a critical economic node & preserves adversary infrastructure.
- **Escalation:** Next, [REDACTED] will cover Phase 2.

Closing and conclusion (Uzair):

- **Closing:** Today, we outlined an **evolving** threat to U.S. critical infrastructure with direct economic consequences and presented a phased response that stabilizes **essential services**, preserves **intelligence**, and maintains **diplomatic leverage**.
- **Call to Action:** Given the impacts of the APT PESTIS, it is imperative that our response is targeted, coordinated, and intelligence-led.
- **Bridge:** Our phased approach enables coordinated remediation and informed decision making as the situation evolves.
- **Conclusion:** Thank you for your time. We welcome your questions.